

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET G — FINAL MASTERY & GRAND CHALLENGE TEST (60 MINS)****CHAPTER 06: DEMOCRACY**

TIME ALLOWED: 60 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-G-06

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET G - Final Mastery & Grand Challenge Test):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Olympiad / NTSE / Advanced Analytical Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed for **Final Curricular Mastery & In-Depth Analytical Rigour**: Target time is **60 Minutes**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **GRAND CHALLENGE SPECIAL:** This final assessment tests your multi-disciplinary analytical reasoning across historical source criticism, geomorphological dynamics, constitutional jurisprudence, and microeconomic market equilibria!

Q1. In political philosophy, how does Montesquieu's doctrine of 'Separation of Powers' (Trias Politica) serve as an indispensable cornerstone of constitutional democracy?

- ☐ A It consolidates all legislative, executive, and judicial authority into the head of state to ensure rapid policy enforcement ☐ B It distributes state power among independent legislative, executive, and judicial branches with reciprocal checks and balances to prevent arbitrary tyranny ☐ C It eliminates judicial review so that parliamentary majorities can override the constitution at will ☐ D It replaces civilian elections with rotating military councils

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Montesquieu formulated that political liberty exists only when legislative, executive, and judicial powers are separated, preventing any single body from exercising tyrannical tyranny over citizens.

Q2. What is the critical distinction between 'Procedural Democracy' and 'Substantive Democracy' in contemporary political theory?

- ☐ A Procedural democracy requires digital EVMs, whereas substantive democracy relies on physical paper ballots ☐ B Procedural democracy focuses strictly on institutional mechanisms (periodic elections, multi-party competition), whereas substantive democracy guarantees real socio-economic equality, human rights, and meaningful public deliberation ☐ C Procedural democracy is practiced only in military dictatorships, while substantive democracy is practiced only in city-states ☐ D Procedural democracy bans all political parties, while substantive democracy permits only one state party

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Procedural democracy satisfies formal constitutional rules (elections, rule of law), while substantive democracy realizes the core values of justice, equality of opportunity, and socio-economic empowerment.

Q3. Under the landmark 'Basic Structure Doctrine' formulated by the Supreme Court of India in *Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala* (1973), which principle protects the core tenets of democracy from parliamentary amendment?

- ☐ A Parliament possesses unfettered sovereignty to repeal Fundamental Rights under Article 368 ☐ B Parliament's constituent power to amend the Constitution does not extend to altering or destroying its foundational features, such as democracy, secularism, rule of law, and judicial review ☐ C The President can suspend elections indefinitely upon cabinet advice ☐ D The executive branch can appoint and dismiss judges without judicial consultation

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The *Kesavananda Bharati* ruling held that while Parliament has broad amending powers under Article 368, it cannot alter the 'Basic Structure' of the Constitution, which includes democracy and republican form of government.

Q4. Which historical case exemplifies how an elected democratic leader systematically dismantled constitutional checks to establish an authoritarian regime through legal decrees?

- ☐ A Robert Mugabe in Zimbabwe amending the constitution, intimidating opposition voters, and controlling the media through ZANU-PF ☐ B Abraham Lincoln signing the Emancipation Proclamation in 1863 ☐ C Nelson Mandela stepping down voluntarily after one term in South Africa in 1999 ☐ D George Washington establishing the two-term presidential convention in 1796

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Robert Mugabe's ZANU-PF government in Zimbabwe used formal constitutional amendments, press censorship, and harassment of opposition activists to entrench authoritarian rule behind a veneer of regular elections.

Q5. Why is the Pakistani military dictator General Pervez Musharraf's issuance of the 'Legal Framework Order' (LFO) in August 2002 considered antithetical to democratic rule?

- ☐ A Because it granted citizens the right to recall military officers ☐ B Because it unilaterally amended Pakistan's Constitution, giving the military President absolute power to dissolve national and provincial assemblies and subordinating civilian governance to a military-dominated National Security Council ☐ C Because it lowered the voting age to 16 years ☐ D Because it abolished political campaign spending limits

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The 2002 Legal Framework Order granted General Musharraf autocratic powers to dismiss elected parliaments, appoint military chiefs, and install military oversight over civilian governance, subverting true democracy.

Q6. How did Mexico's Institutional Revolutionary Party (PRI) maintain unbroken political dominance for 71 years (1929–2000) despite conducting regular six-year presidential elections?

- ☐ A By strictly following fair campaign rules and winning 100% of voluntary votes without state interference ☐ B By deploying state machinery, coercing civil servants to attend rallies, forcing public school teachers to mobilize parents, and shifting polling booths at the eleventh hour to disenfranchise opposition voters ☐ C By conducting all voting through transparent electronic voting machines monitored by the United Nations ☐ D By formally outlawing the existence of all opposition political parties in the constitution

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The PRI weaponized government patronage, coerced civil servants and unions, monopolized media coverage, and manipulated election day infrastructure, creating an unfair playing field.

Q7. What fundamental democratic principle is violated when Fiji's electoral system accords greater mathematical weight to the vote of an indigenous Fijian than to that of an Indo-Fijian citizen?

- ☐ A Principle of Proportional Representation ☐ B Principle of 'One Person, One Vote, One Value' (Universal Political Equality) ☐ C Principle of Judicial Review ☐ D Principle of Executive Discretion

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Democratic equality mandates that every adult citizen possesses one vote and each vote carries equal mathematical value. Weighted voting based on ethnicity violates Universal Political Equality.

Q8. In A.V. Dicey's classical formulation, what are the three core components of the 'Rule of Law' that distinguish a democracy from an autocracy?

- ☐ A Supremacy of regular law over arbitrary power, equality before the law for all citizens, and constitutional law originating from ordinary judicial determinations ☐ B Absolute royal immunity, retroactive criminal punishment, and secret courts ☐ C Executive decrees overriding judicial verdicts, hereditary magistrates, and censorship ☐ D Mandatory military rule, public curfews, and suspension of habeas corpus

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Dicey defined the Rule of Law by three tenets: absence of arbitrary power (supremacy of regular law), equal subjection of all classes to ordinary law, and the primacy of individual rights enforced by courts.

Q9. Which criterion differentiates a 'Majoritarian Tyranny' from a genuine constitutional democracy?

- ☐ A In a majoritarian tyranny, electoral majority rule operates without respecting fundamental minority rights, whereas a constitutional democracy constrains majority power through entrenched constitutional safeguards and civil liberties ☐ B Majoritarian tyrannies hold zero parliamentary debates, while democracies have no written laws ☐ C In majoritarian systems, judges are chosen by foreign ambassadors ☐ D Constitutional democracies ban political parties from gaining more than 50% of the vote

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Democracy is not merely 51% subjugating 49%. Constitutional democracy protects fundamental rights of minorities against majoritarian overreach through institutional checks and judicial review.

Q10. What argument did Nobel laureate Amartya Sen advance regarding democracy and the prevention of catastrophic famines?

- ☐ A Famines occur solely due to technological failures in grain silos ☐ B No substantial famine has ever occurred in an independent democratic country with a relatively free press, because democratic governments face public scrutiny and electoral accountability to respond urgently to food shortages ☐ C Authoritarian regimes distribute food more equitably during crises because they do not waste time on parliamentary debates ☐ D Famines are caused exclusively by global export tariffs

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Sen demonstrated that democracy, through opposition criticism, free journalism, and periodic elections, forces governments to take prompt preventive action against famines, contrasting democratic India with Mao's China.

Q11. In ancient Athens, what was the function of the democratic institution of 'Ostracism'?

- ☐ A Electing the head of the Olympian priesthood for life ☐ B Voting on broken pottery shards (ostraka) to temporarily exile any prominent political leader deemed a threat to democratic stability or aspiring to tyranny for 10 years ☐ C Imposing trade tariffs on Spartan grain merchants ☐ D Awarding Olympic gold medals to naval admirals

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Athenian citizens inscribed names on pottery fragments (ostraka); if 6,000 votes were cast, the individual was exiled for 10 years without loss of property, neutralising potential tyrants.

Q12. Why does a genuine democracy require an 'Autonomous and Independent Judiciary'?

- ☐ A To draft the government's economic budgets and tax policies ☐ B To ensure that laws enacted by parliament and executive orders comply with constitutional norms and protect citizens' fundamental rights from state overreach ☐ C To enforce mandatory voting for every citizen under penalty of prison ☐ D To replace parliament during national emergencies

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: An independent judiciary acts as the sentinel qui vive of the constitution, possessing the power of judicial review to strike down unconstitutional legislation and protect individual freedoms.

Q13. In the Polish struggle for democracy leading up to 1989, what was 'Solidarity' (Solidarność)?

- ☐ A A royalist military squadron loyal to the Soviet Union ☐ B An independent, non-communist trade union led by Lech Wałęsa that mobilized civil disobedience and forced the communist regime to conduct free multi-party elections ☐ C A foreign multinational corporation that owned the Gdansk shipyard ☐ D A state-sponsored censorship committee regulating Warsaw newspapers

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Solidarity arose in the Gdansk shipyards under Lech Wałęsa, becoming a mass social movement that shattered single-party communist monopoly and ushered in democratic transitions in Eastern Europe.

Q14. Why is freedom of speech and expression (protected under Article 19(1)(a) of the Indian Constitution) considered the 'lifeblood' of a democratic polity?

- ☐ A It guarantees that government officials can never be investigated for corruption ☐ B It allows citizens and the press to question executive policies, debate public issues, expose administrative misconduct, and form informed collective opinions essential for electoral accountability ☐ C It permits commercial advertisers to make false medical claims ☐ D It exempts citizens from paying municipal taxes

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Freedom of speech enables vibrant public deliberation, oversight of governmental power, and peaceful dissent, without which periodic voting becomes an empty formality.

Q15. What distinguishes direct democracy from representative indirect democracy?

- ☐ A Direct democracy uses paper ballots; representative democracy uses electronic voting machines ☐ B In direct democracy, citizens directly vote on laws and policy decisions (e.g., Swiss referendums and ancient Athens), whereas in representative democracy, citizens elect legislators to deliberate and enact laws on their behalf ☐ C Direct democracy exists only in military states; representative democracy exists only in monarchies ☐ D Representative democracy allows monarchs to veto citizen votes directly

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: In direct democracy, eligible citizens vote directly on legislation (referendums/initiatives), while representative democracy delegates legislative authority to elected parliamentary representatives.

Q16. Which institutional mechanism provides 'Horizontal Accountability' within a democratic constitutional framework?

- ☐ A Voters casting ballots every five years during general elections ☐ B Internal checks between co-equal state branches: the legislature, executive, judiciary, comptroller and auditor general, and human rights commissions ☐ C Trade unions calling general industrial strikes across factories ☐ D Foreign diplomatic embassies issuing quarterly press releases

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Horizontal accountability refers to internal state oversight where separate constitutional organs (judiciary, legislative committees, CAG, ombudsman) monitor and check executive transgressions.

Q17. Why is the Chinese system of government considered non-democratic despite holding periodic elections to the National People's Congress?

- ☐ A Because only 10 people in China are permitted to vote ☐ B Because candidates must secure prior approval from the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) or its allied eight small parties, guaranteeing a one-party monopoly with zero genuine opposition alternatives ☐ C Because Chinese elections are conducted entirely by foreign software corporations ☐ D Because voting is conducted solely in the Latin language

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: China's single-party system lacks true political contestation: no candidate can contest without CCP clearance, denying voters an authentic choice to change the governing regime.

Q18. What is the defining purpose of a 'Constitutional Bill of Rights' in modern democracies?

- ☐ A To grant absolute powers to the police to bypass judicial warrants during riots ☐ B To place essential individual liberties beyond the reach of transient legislative majorities and state encroachment ☐ C To outline tax payment schedules for corporate enterprises ☐ D To define military ranks in the armed forces

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: A Bill of Rights enshrines inviolable human liberties (speech, faith, equality, due process) as supreme constitutional law, insulating citizens against arbitrary executive or legislative infringement.

Q19. In Alexis de Tocqueville's classic analysis 'Democracy in America' (1835), what did he identify as a major peril inherent to egalitarian democratic societies?

- ☐ A The permanent restoration of feudal aristocracies ☐ B The 'Tyranny of the Majority' and conformist social pressure stifling intellectual originality and minority individuality ☐ C The complete disappearance of commercial agriculture ☐ D The immediate collapse of all federal courts

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Tocqueville warned that in egalitarian democracies, overwhelming majoritarian consensus could tyrannize minority viewpoints, producing cultural conformism and intellectual docility.

Q20. Why does democratic governance lead to better policy decisions compared to autocratic rule?

- ☐ A Because democratic decisions are made instantaneously by one military general ☐ B Because democratic policy formulation involves open debate, multi-stakeholder consultations, legislative scrutiny, and consideration of diverse viewpoints, reducing the risk of catastrophic blind spots ☐ C Because democracies rely entirely on artificial intelligence rather than human ministers ☐ D Because democracies automatically abolish all public disagreements

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Deliberative democracy requires extensive consultation and consensus-building, allowing errors to be detected and corrected before implementation, unlike hasty autocratic decrees.

Q21. What role does the 'Loyal Opposition' play in a functioning parliamentary democracy?

- ☐ A To violently overthrow the government through armed insurrection ☐ B To scrutinize government bills, demand executive transparency, voice alternate policy paradigms, and stand ready as a credible constitutional alternative to form the government ☐ C To agree with every ruling party policy without question ☐ D To manage the central bank's foreign exchange reserves

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The parliamentary Opposition acts as a constructive critic: it questions ministers, debates policy flaws in standing committees, and represents dissenting citizen interests within constitutional bounds.

Q22. Which criterion constitutes the most reliable test of whether a nation is a genuine democracy?

- ☐ A Whether the governing ruling party can actually lose a free and fair election and peacefully surrender state power to the opposition ☐ B The total number of military fighter aircraft in its air force ☐ C The height of the prime minister's official residence ☐ D Whether the country has a single national state religion

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Adam Przeworski famously encapsulated democracy as 'a system in which parties lose elections.' The real test is the incumbents' willingness to accept electoral defeat and transfer power peacefully.

Q23. What is the danger of 'Democratic Backsliding' (or Autocratic Legalism) observed in contemporary global politics?

- ☐ A The sudden conquest of a country by alien spacecraft ☐ B The gradual, subtle erosion of democratic norms, judicial independence, press freedom, and electoral integrity by elected leaders using constitutional means from within ☐ C The spontaneous increase in public voter turnout to 100% ☐ D The total elimination of paper currency in financial markets

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Democratic backsliding involves elected incumbents systematically subverting checks and balances, weakening courts, and capturing public media under a facade of legality.

Q24. Under the concept of 'Deliberative Democracy', the legitimacy of a state law derives primarily from:

- ☐ A The sheer brute force and military weaponry possessed by the ruling police ☐ B The quality of open, inclusive, reasoned public argumentation and collective deliberation among free and equal citizens prior to enactment ☐ C The secret instructions given by foreign financial creditors ☐ D The astrological alignment of the stars on the day of the vote

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Deliberative democracy (developed by Habermas and Rawls) holds that legitimate law emerges from authentic, reasoned dialogue and inclusive justification among equal citizens, not just raw headcounts.

Q25. Why is the right to peacefully assemble and protest protected as an essential element of democratic citizenship?

- ☐ A It enables citizens to hold public authorities accountable between election cycles, express grievances, and influence policy decisions without resorting to violence ☐ B It allows citizens to permanently block all hospitals and railways without justification ☐ C It replaces the need for municipal police departments entirely ☐ D It automatically repeals any law voted by parliament upon demand

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Peaceful assembly provides a vital conduit for civic participation between elections, allowing marginalized communities to highlight grievances and advocate reform within constitutional parameters.

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET G)

01 A B C D	02 A B C D	03 A B C D	04 A B C D	05 A B C D
06 A B C D	07 A B C D	08 A B C D	09 A B C D	10 A B C D
11 A B C D	12 A B C D	13 A B C D	14 A B C D	15 A B C D
16 A B C D	17 A B C D	18 A B C D	19 A B C D	20 A B C D
21 A B C D	22 A B C D	23 A B C D	24 A B C D	25 A B C D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & IN-DEPTH SCHOLARLY EXPLANATIONS (SET G)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Scholarly Analysis
1	B	Montesquieu formulated that political liberty exists only when legislative, executive, and judicial powers are separated, preventing any single body from exercising tyrannical tyranny over citizens.
2	B	Procedural democracy satisfies formal constitutional rules (elections, rule of law), while substantive democracy realizes the core values of justice, equality of opportunity, and socio-economic empowerment.
3	B	The Kesavananda Bharati ruling held that while Parliament has broad amending powers under Article 368, it cannot alter the 'Basic Structure' of the Constitution, which includes democracy and republican form of government.
4	A	Robert Mugabe's ZANU-PF government in Zimbabwe used formal constitutional amendments, press censorship, and harassment of opposition activists to entrench authoritarian rule behind a veneer of regular elections.
5	B	The 2002 Legal Framework Order granted General Musharraf autocratic powers to dismiss elected parliaments, appoint military chiefs, and install military oversight over civilian governance, subverting true democracy.
6	B	The PRI weaponized government patronage, coerced civil servants and unions, monopolized media coverage, and manipulated election day infrastructure, creating an unfair playing field.
7	B	Democratic equality mandates that every adult citizen possesses one vote and each vote carries equal mathematical value. Weighted voting based on ethnicity violates Universal Political Equality.
8	A	Dicey defined the Rule of Law by three tenets: absence of arbitrary power (supremacy of regular law), equal subjection of all classes to ordinary law, and the primacy of individual rights enforced by courts.
9	A	Democracy is not merely 51% subjugating 49%. Constitutional democracy protects fundamental rights of minorities against majoritarian overreach through institutional checks and judicial review.
10	B	Sen demonstrated that democracy, through opposition criticism, free journalism, and periodic elections, forces governments to take prompt preventive action against famines, contrasting democratic India with Mao's China.
11	B	Athenian citizens inscribed names on pottery fragments (ostraka); if 6,000 votes were cast, the individual was exiled for 10 years without loss of property, neutralising potential tyrants.
12	B	An independent judiciary acts as the sentinel qui vive of the constitution, possessing the power of judicial review to strike down unconstitutional legislation and protect individual freedoms.
13	B	Solidarity arose in the Gdansk shipyards under Lech Wałęsa, becoming a mass social movement that shattered single-party communist monopoly and ushered in democratic transitions in Eastern Europe.
14	B	Freedom of speech enables vibrant public deliberation, oversight of governmental power, and peaceful dissent, without which periodic voting becomes an empty formality.
15	B	In direct democracy, eligible citizens vote directly on legislation (referendums/initiatives), while representative democracy delegates legislative authority to elected parliamentary representatives.
16	B	Horizontal accountability refers to internal state oversight where separate constitutional organs (judiciary, legislative committees, CAG, ombudsman) monitor and check executive transgressions.
17	B	China's single-party system lacks true political contestation: no candidate can contest without CCP clearance, denying voters an authentic choice to change the governing regime.
18	B	A Bill of Rights enshrines inviolable human liberties (speech, faith, equality, due process) as supreme constitutional law, insulating citizens against arbitrary executive or legislative infringement.
19	B	Tocqueville warned that in egalitarian democracies, overwhelming majoritarian consensus could tyrannize minority viewpoints, producing cultural conformism and intellectual docility.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Scholarly Analysis
20	B	Deliberative democracy requires extensive consultation and consensus-building, allowing errors to be detected and corrected before implementation, unlike hasty autocratic decrees.
21	B	The parliamentary Opposition acts as a constructive critic: it questions ministers, debates policy flaws in standing committees, and represents dissenting citizen interests within constitutional bounds.
22	A	Adam Przeworski famously encapsulated democracy as 'a system in which parties lose elections.' The real test is the incumbents' willingness to accept electoral defeat and transfer power peacefully.
23	B	Democratic backsliding involves elected incumbents systematically subverting checks and balances, weakening courts, and capturing public media under a facade of legality.
24	B	Deliberative democracy (developed by Habermas and Rawls) holds that legitimate law emerges from authentic, reasoned dialogue and inclusive justification among equal citizens, not just raw headcounts.
25	A	Peaceful assembly provides a vital conduit for civic participation between elections, allowing marginalized communities to highlight grievances and advocate reform within constitutional parameters.